



Pocket of Calm

A guided journaling companion for small returns

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THE RITUAL LIBRARY

A note before you begin

This book and deck are personal reflection tools. They are not therapy, medical care, diagnosis, crisis support, or a substitute for professional advice. Skip any prompt that does not fit; seek appropriate professional or urgent support when needed.

The boxed deck is optional. This paperback companion includes all 54 prompts as a stand-alone journal.

When a blank journal is too much, begin with one small question.

Choose a prompt at random, start with the family that fits, or read one and close the book. There is no streak to keep and no right answer to find.

How I want to use this

You can use this book in five minutes or over many months.

PLACES I MAY KEEP THIS BOOK

PROMPTS OR MOMENTS I WANT TO RETURN TO

A SENTENCE I WANT TO PRACTICE

ARRIVE · CARD 01

Name three things in this room that make you feel a little more here.

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

ARRIVE · CARD 02

**Let your eyes land on one ordinary object.
What do you notice about it?**

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

ARRIVE · CARD 03

Where is your body being supported right now?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

ARRIVE · CARD 04

What sound is closest? What sound is farthest away?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

ARRIVE · CARD 05

If you could give this moment a weather report, what would it be?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

ARRIVE · CARD 06

Notice your hands. What are they doing, holding, or asking for?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

ARRIVE · CARD 07

Name one thing that is true in this exact minute.

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

ARRIVE · CARD 08

What changes when you lengthen only the exhale, naturally and without force?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

ARRIVE · CARD 09

What is one place you could make two inches more comfortable?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

SOFTEN • CARD 10

**What is one sentence you would rather hear
than the one your inner critic is offering?**

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

SOFTEN · CARD 11

What would “kind enough” sound like here?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

SOFTEN • CARD 12

What would you say to someone you love in this exact moment?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

SOFTEN · CARD 13

What are you allowed to be learning?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

SOFTEN · CARD 14

Which expectation could become a request instead?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

SOFTEN • CARD 15

What deserves less judgment today?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

SOFTEN • CARD 16

What can be true without being fixed tonight?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

SOFTEN • CARD 17

What is one thing you did that was quietly difficult?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

SOFTEN · CARD 18

What would it mean to take your own side for five minutes?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

NOURISH · CARD 19

What kind of comfort sounds possible, not perfect?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

NOURISH · CARD 20

What sensory cue might help: warmth, water, air, texture, quiet, or movement?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

NOURISH · CARD 21

What would make the next hour five percent gentler?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

NOURISH · CARD 22

What have you been needing but postponing?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

NOURISH · CARD 23

What is one ordinary thing that helps you feel more like yourself?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

NOURISH · CARD 24

If care were practical today, what would it look like?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

NOURISH · CARD 25

What would a good-enough pause include?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

NOURISH · CARD 26

What do you want less of around you right now?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

NOURISH · CARD 27

What is one small pleasure you do not have to earn?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

REACH · CARD 28

What kind of support would make this lighter to carry?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

REACH · CARD 29

Who could receive one honest sentence from you?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

REACH · CARD 30

What boundary would protect your next hour?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

REACH · CARD 31

What question could you ask instead of trying to guess?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

REACH · CARD 32

What task is not yours to solve alone?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

REACH · CARD 33

What would a clear “not today” make room for?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

REACH · CARD 34

Where could you ask for help before you are at capacity?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

REACH · CARD 35

What conversation needs a softer beginning?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

REACH · CARD 36

What do you need someone else to understand about today?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

CONTINUE

CONTINUE · CARD 37

What has been helping, even a little?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

What did you do today that you almost failed to count?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

Where did you choose a sustainable pace?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

CONTINUE · CARD 40

What is one thing you have already survived or learned?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

CONTINUE · CARD 41

What would make progress feel less like a scoreboard?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

What is worth repeating tomorrow?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

What part of your routine is quietly working?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

CONTINUE · CARD 44

What did you notice with curiosity instead of judgment?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

What is one reason to trust your ability to continue?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

RESET • CARD 46

If today needed to be smaller, what could become optional?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

What is the next physical action—not the whole project?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

RESET • CARD 48

What can wait until you have more information or energy?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

RESET • CARD 49

What can you set down for ten minutes?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

RESET • CARD 50

What is one kind way to end this loop?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

RESET • CARD 51

What needs a list, a timer, a glass of water, or a message?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

RESET

RESET • CARD 52

What would you like the next hour to feel like?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

RESET • CARD 53

What is one decision you do not have to make right now?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

RESET • CARD 54

What would “enough for today” look like?

You can write one word, fill the page, speak the answer, or simply keep the card nearby.

DATE / MOMENT

WHAT I NOTICE

WHAT WOULD HELP NEXT?

Choose a card, a memory, a feeling, or nothing at all.

Open reflection

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